

vision**2**learn

Understanding Autism

Hints
and
Tips

Unit 3



Contents

Session 1 – Understand speech, language and communication in individuals with autism	4
Session 2 – Understand how social interaction may differ in individuals with autism	6
Session 3 – Know strategies that are used to support communication and social interaction for individuals with autism	7

Hints and Tips Unit 3

The information in this guide will be helpful to you when you are ready to complete your assessment for the following unit:

Unit 3 - Communication and social interaction in individuals with autism

Session 1 – Understand speech, language and communication in individuals with autism

- Q1.** In the table below, Outline the **processes** required to communicate using
- speech
 - language. [1.1]

For this question you need to ensure that you outline the processes for both speech and language. processes include cognitive (interpretation and processing of language), social and physical (the mechanics or articulation of speech).

- Q2.** In the box below, **describe** how speech and language development may be delayed or affected for individuals with autism. [1.2]

This is a describe question so make sure that you provide good detail in your answer. As well as the information in the course materials the following website has some useful information that you may find useful.

[Autism Spectrum Disorder: Communication Problems in Children | NIDCD \(nih.gov\)](https://www.nidcd.nih.gov/health/autism-spectrum-disorder-communication-problems-children)

- Q3.** In the box below, **describe** different **forms of communication** used by individuals with autism. [1.3]

This is a describe question so make sure that you provide good detail in your answer. All the information required for this can be found in session 1 page 3 you just need to put it in your own words.

- Q4. In the box below, **describe** the difficulties an individual with autism may have in communicating verbally when:
- processing verbal information
 - interpreting verbal information [1.4]

When answering this question make sure that you differentiate between processing and interpreting verbal information.

Session 2 – Understand how social interaction may differ in individuals with autism

Q1. In the box below, **describe** how social development may be delayed or affected for individuals with autism. [2.1]

This is a describe question so make sure that you provide good detail in your response. All of the information relating to this can be found on page 1 of session 2 you just need to put it in your own words.

Q2. In the box below, **describe** the difficulties individuals with autism may experience with **social interaction**. [2.2]

This is a describe question so make sure that you provide good detail in your answer. Things to consider are:

- reading facial expression and body language
- social imagination
- social inhibition
- appropriate use of eye contact.

You may also find the following website helpful.

[What is autism](#)

Q3. In the box below, **explain** the links between social development and speech and language development. [2.3]

This is an explain question so make sure that you provide good detail in your answer. There are a number of links discussed in the video on page 1 of session 2.

Session 3 – Know strategies that are used to support communication and social interaction for individuals with autism

Q1. In the table below, **identify** a range of methods that could be used when communicating with an individual with autism. [3.1]

This is an identify question so you only need to list or bullet point your responses. There are a number of communication methods discussed on page 1 of session 3.

Q2. In the Table below, **outline** a range of **strategies** that could be used to support communication and social interaction. [3.2]

For this question you need to consider a range of strategies. A good way to look at this is how strategies enable methods and equipment to be used in a way that actively encourages social interaction, for example:

- Picture Exchange Communication System (PECS)
- Makaton
- Social Stories
- music cues
- comic strip conversations
- visual/graphics
- technology.

Q3. In the box below, **describe** how communication can be adapted to meet the needs and preferences of each individual. [3.3]

This is a describe question so make sure that you provide good detail in your answer. The two videos on page 1 of session 3 contain all the information you need to help you to answer the question.

Q4. In the box below, **explain** how a **constructive environment** can be created to aid communication and social interaction. [3.4]

When formulating your answer for this you should consider the types of environment, for example, free from distractions, low arousal. Watch the video on page 2 of session 3 for guidance with this and the following website has some information that you may find useful.

[How to create an autism-friendly environment - Living Autism](#)

Q5. In the box below, **describe** the role of **specialists** in supporting communication and social interaction. [3.5]

For this question you need to describe the roles of different specialists such as speech and language therapists and how they can provide support to enhance communication and social interaction.